

MICHAEL HODGDON

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SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer with experience in Cloud Security, Platform Engineering, and Developer Experience (DevEx). Currently Lead for GitHub Enterprise at PayPal, architecting governance and automation for a global developer population. Expert in building CI/CD frameworks, enforcing enterprise-wide security-as-code, and scaling infrastructure to handle 200M+ daily calls. Holder of a U.S. Patent in behavior analytics and data exfiltration prevention.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Cloud:** GCP (Professional Cloud Architect), Kubernetes (GKE), Docker.
- **GitHub:** GitHub Enterprise Admin, GitHub Actions, GitHub Apps, Webhooks.
- **DevSecOps:** Terraform, Helm, ArgoCD, Jenkins, Harness, Ansible, Puppet, JFrog Artifactory.
- **Security:** CISSP, CCSP, Traceable (API Security), Aqua (Vulnerability Management), Signal Sciences (WAF)
- **Languages:** Python, Bash

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PAYPAL | Scottsdale, AZ

Staff Software Engineer | 2020 - Present

Information Security Engineer | 2016 - 2020

- **Branch Protection Standard:** Defined a branch-protection eligibility framework, exception/approval workflow, and self-service tool used company-wide.
- **Policy Enforcement:** Set and enforced GitHub-wide policy, org creation, service-account approval, mandatory dual-approval merges, production branch protection.
- **Migration Engineering:** Built the GitHub/Jira/ServiceNow orchestration behind PayPal's move off self-hosted GitHub, cutting per-repo migration time from hours to minutes and proving throughput above 1,800 repos/day against a 30k repo backlog.
- **Platform Reliability:** Traced recurring CI/CD failures across multiple teams to an undetected single point of failure in GitHub's webhook path and implemented redundant architecture.
- **AI Support Tooling:** Found that an AI support bot for a CTO-tracked, company-wide migration channel was fabricating answers from contradictory docs; audited three months and 3,500+ requests to isolate and fix the ~15% of volume it was mishandling.

- **Security Incident Response:** Responded to platform security incidents on GitHub, including an insider-threat data-exfiltration case and critical secret-exposure remediations, coordinating directly with InfoSec and GitHub Support to contain each quickly.
- **API Security at Scale:** Scaled Traceable's API-security coverage to 200M+ daily calls within 72 hours, keeping real-time detection ahead of production traffic growth rather than leaving a coverage gap.
- **Vulnerability Management Modernization:** Migrated the Aqua vulnerability-management platform off legacy VMs onto GKE/SaaS, extending automated scanning visibility to 1M+ container images.
- **Infrastructure as Code:** Automated JFrog Artifactory HA upgrades with Terraform and Helm, cutting a multi-sprint manual migration down to under four hours.

EXPEDIA GROUP | Scottsdale, AZ, Senior Linux System Administrator

VONAGE BUSINESS | Scottsdale, AZ, Senior Systems Engineer

ONENECK IT SOLUTIONS | Scottsdale, AZ, Unix Systems Administrator III

PATENTS

- **U.S. Patent 11,818,219:** Session management and behavior analytics to prevent data exfiltration. (Granted Nov 2023)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect
- CISSP & CCSP
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate
- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate
- LPIC-1, LPIC-2, LPIC-3 (Linux Professional Institute)

EDUCATION

- **Associate of Applied Science: Linux Networking Administration** | Mesa Community College, AZ